

NORTHEASTERN AFRICA

NORTHEASTERN AFRICA CONTAINS EGYPT and Sudan, two desert lands watered by the Nile River, and the region known as the Horn of Africa, shaped like an animal horn, which consists of Somalia, Djibouti, Ethiopia, and Eritrea, which are among the poorest countries in the world. The boundaries that divide these countries date from the last 100 years and follow borders drawn up by the old colonial rulers of the area. However, many people that live here are nomadic herders and take little notice of the borders as they travel over vast areas in search of pasture for their animals.



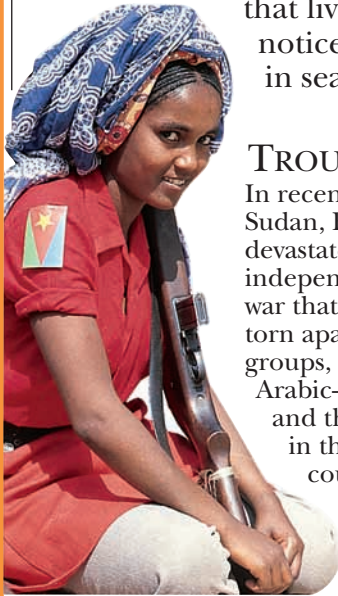
BASIC TOOLS

Farming methods in the area are often inefficient, and simple tools, such as hoes, digging sticks, and sickles, are widely used. The ox-drawn scratch plow (above) is light and can be carried to scattered fields. But it only turns over the surface layer of the soil and does not allow nutrients to spread deeper, so after a few years, the soil is no longer fertile.

TROUBLED LANDS

In recent years the countries of Somalia, Sudan, Ethiopia, and Eritrea have been devastated by war. In 1993, Eritrea gained independence from Ethiopia after a civil war that lasted 20 years. Somalia has been torn apart by civil war between its rival groups, or clans. Conflict between the Arabic-speaking Muslims in the north and the African, non-Muslim peoples in the south of Sudan ravaged the country for years.

Thousands of Eritrean women fought alongside men in the war against Ethiopia, and many held positions of command.



The White Nile meanders slowly through the Sudd, a vast region of dense reed swamps in Sudan.

The White Nile and the Blue Nile meet at Khartoum in Sudan to form the Nile River.

Many birds, including storks, herons, and pelicans, make their home in the Sudd.

The Blue Nile begins at Lake Tana. It flows through the mountains of Ethiopia, collecting rainfall along the way.

Fertile farmland

As the Nile reaches the border of Sudan and Egypt, it flows into Lake Nasser, one of the world's largest artificial lakes. The lake was created by the building of the Aswan High Dam.

North of the Aswan Dam, the Nile is surrounded by desert, but rich, fertile land lies along the banks of the river.

Feluccas are now mainly used by tourists.

THE NILE RIVER

The world's longest river, the Nile River, flows northward from Lake Victoria in Kenya, through the Sahara Desert, to the Mediterranean Sea. It passes through Ethiopia, Sudan, and Egypt, providing precious water for drinking, farming, and fishing. The river is also a major tourist attraction. People travel along the Nile on cruise liners and traditional sailing boats called *feluccas* to see the ancient sites of Egypt.

